

D595

Public Health Capstone

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

On a Friday evening, tests find E. coli in a town's water system. The source is not yet known. The town's popular summer festival starts Saturday. What should the health department's first public message do?

- A. Announce now: E. coli was found, the cause is under investigation, boil water, and the next update is at noon Saturday.
- B. Promise the water will be safe by Monday.
- C. Wait until the cause is confirmed so the message is complete.
- D. Announce the festival is postponed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement by a spokesperson during an outbreak goes against crisis and emergency risk communication principles?

- A. "We know this is frightening, and we're working around the clock."
- B. "Boil tap water for one minute before drinking."
- C. "We don't yet know the source; we'll update you at 5 p.m."
- D. "We will not comment until the investigation is complete."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A draft heat alert, which will go out on the county's new text alert system, reads: "Individuals with preexisting cardiovascular conditions should minimize exertional activities during periods of elevated ambient temperature." Which rewrite best fits plain language?

- A. "Everyone must stay inside at all times."
- B. Shorten it to fit one text message and keep the terms.
- C. "If you have heart disease, stay cool and rest during the hottest hours."
- D. Keep the wording and add heat-illness statistics for credibility.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A vaccine made by a company headquartered overseas lowers the risk of severe illness from 4 in 1,000 to 1 in 1,000 over a season. A reporter asks for the absolute risk reduction. What should you say?

- A. 3 in 1,000 (0.3 percentage points).
- B. 75%.
- C. 3%.
- D. 1 in 1,000.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Using the same numbers (risk falls from 4 in 1,000 to 1 in 1,000), about how many people must be vaccinated to prevent one case of severe illness?

- A. 1,000.
- B. 0.003.
- C. About 1.33.
- D. About 333.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A state-funded HPV vaccine campaign launching in October targets both parents of 11- to 12-year-olds and young adults aged 19 to 26. Parents worry about safety and age; young adults say they didn't know they were still eligible. What approach fits best?

- A. Wait until after October to align with the grant cycle.
- B. One message for both groups to save money.
- C. Focus only on safety for both groups.
- D. Build separate messages and channels for parents and for young adults.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A county is designing a sunscreen campaign for teens at public pools, which opened late this year due to repairs. Which message frame is most likely to work?

- A. Fear appeals work best for every health behavior.
- B. Gain frame: "Sunscreen keeps your skin healthy and looking good."
- C. Loss frame: "Skip sunscreen and you risk skin cancer."
- D. Focus on the pools reopening after repairs.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which frame is generally more effective for encouraging women to get a screening mammogram?

- A. No frame; just list the clinic hours.
- B. Gain frame: benefits of screening.
- C. Loss frame: what you may lose by not getting screened.
- D. A neutral statistics-only frame always works best.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

Free flu shots are advertised on buses and radio, and awareness surveys show most factory workers know about them. Shots are offered only at the downtown office, 9 to 5 on weekdays, and the ads won a regional design award. Uptake among night-shift workers is low. Which P should change?

- A. Place: offer shots at the factory or in the evening.
- B. Promotion: run more ads.
- C. Promotion: enter the ads for another award.
- D. Product: switch to a different vaccine brand.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Workers know about a free screening program and can reach it easily, but they say the three-hour wait costs them lost wages. Which P is the barrier?

- A.** None; price does not apply to free services.
- B.** Promotion.
- C.** Price.
- D.** Place.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

Booster uptake is low among farmworker families who distrust government agencies. The county recently repaved the main road to the farms. Who would likely be the most effective messenger?

- A.** More official flyers from the county.
- B.** Community health workers from the farmworker community.
- C.** A national celebrity with no local ties.
- D.** The state health commissioner.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A rumor that a childhood vaccine contains tracking microchips spreads through a popular online cooking group. Which draft correction follows best practice?

- A.** Ignore all rumors always, so they fade on their own.
- B.** Start with what the vaccine contains, note the rumor once as false, explain, and restate the fact.
- C.** Post a long technical paper on vaccine manufacturing.
- D.** Headline: "Vaccines DO NOT contain microchips!"

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

On a Friday evening, tests find E. coli in a town's water system. The source is not yet known. ~~The town's popular summer festival starts Saturday.~~ What should the health department's first public message do?

Target word: CERC first message **Decides:** People must act now; facts are incomplete.

A	Correct	Be first, be right, be credible, with a clear action.
B	Absolute language	Over-reassurance damages trust if it proves wrong.
C	Inverted operation	Delay leaves people drinking unsafe water.
D	Camouflage	Addresses the festival, not what residents must do about water.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

Which statement by a spokesperson during an outbreak goes against crisis and emergency risk communication principles?

Target word: spot the violation **Decides:** Withholding information until everything is known.

A	Adjacent category	Expressing empathy supports credibility.
B	Confusion set	A clear action step, which CERC calls for.
C	Inverted operation	Admitting uncertainty with an update time is good practice.
D	Correct	Violates be first; silence invites rumor.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A draft heat alert, ~~which will go out on the county's new text alert system,~~ reads: "Individuals with preexisting cardiovascular conditions should minimize exertional activities during periods of elevated ambient temperature." Which rewrite best fits plain language?

Target word: plain-language rewrite **Decides:** Short, everyday words, action first.

A	Absolute language	Simple, but inaccurate and overbroad.
B	Camouflage	Fitting the channel does not fix the jargon.
C	Correct	Plain words and a clear action.
D	Adjacent category	More data adds length and difficulty.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A vaccine ~~made by a company headquartered overseas~~ lowers the risk of severe illness from 4 in 1,000 to 1 in 1,000 over a season. A reporter asks for the absolute risk reduction. What should you say?

Target word: absolute risk reduction **Decides:** $4/1,000 - 1/1,000$.

A	Correct	The absolute difference in risk.
B	Adjacent category	That is the relative reduction ($3 \div 4$).
C	Confusion set	Treats 3 in 1,000 as 3 in 100.
D	Wrong stem number	The remaining risk, not the reduction.

5. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

Using the same numbers (risk falls from 4 in 1,000 to 1 in 1,000), about how many people must be vaccinated to prevent one case of severe illness?

Target word: number needed to vaccinate **Decides:** $1 \div \text{absolute risk reduction}$ ($3/1,000$).

A	Dropped element	Ignores the 3 cases prevented.
B	Inverted operation	That is the risk reduction itself, not its reciprocal.
C	Adjacent category	Uses the relative reduction ($1 \div 0.75$).
D	Correct	$1,000 \div 3 \approx 333$.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A ~~state-funded~~ HPV vaccine campaign ~~launching in October~~ targets both parents of 11- to 12-year-olds and young adults aged 19 to 26. Parents worry about safety and age; young adults say they didn't know they were still eligible. What approach fits best?

Target word: segmentation **Decides:** Two groups with different barriers.

A	Camouflage	Timing and funding do not decide the approach.
B	Dropped element	Ignores the different concerns.
C	Adjacent category	Fits parents but misses young adults' eligibility gap.
D	Correct	Tailoring to each segment's barrier.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A county is designing a sunscreen campaign for teens at public pools, ~~which opened late this year due to repairs~~. Which message frame is most likely to work?

Target word: frame for prevention **Decides:** Sunscreen is a prevention behavior.

A	Absolute language	Frame effectiveness depends on behavior type.
B	Correct	Gain frames suit prevention behaviors.
C	Inverted operation	Loss frames suit detection behaviors.
D	Camouflage	Not a framing choice.

8. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

Which frame is generally more effective for encouraging women to get a screening mammogram?

Target word: frame for detection **Decides:** Screening is a detection behavior.

A	Dropped element	Framing still shapes the message.
B	Inverted operation	Gain frames suit prevention.
C	Correct	Loss frames suit detection behaviors.
D	Absolute language	No single frame fits every behavior.

9. Answer A Concept 6

Free flu shots are advertised on buses and radio, and awareness surveys show most factory workers know about them. Shots are offered only at the downtown office, 9 to 5 on weekdays, ~~and the ads won a regional design award~~. Uptake among night-shift workers is low. Which P should change?

Target word: which P **Decides:** Awareness is high; the barrier is where and when.

A	Correct	Access, not awareness, is the barrier.
B	Adjacent category	Awareness is already high.
C	Camouflage	Awards do not fix access.
D	Confusion set	The shot itself is not the barrier.

10. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

Workers know about a free screening program and can reach it easily, but they say the three-hour wait costs them lost wages. Which P is the barrier?

Target word: which P from the barrier **Decides:** Time and lost wages are costs.

A	Absolute language	Non-money costs count as price.
B	Confusion set	They already know about it.
C	Correct	Price includes time and lost wages.
D	Adjacent category	They can reach it easily.

11. Answer B Concept 7

Booster uptake is low among farmworker families who distrust government agencies. ~~The county recently repaved the main road to the farms~~. Who would likely be the most effective messenger?

Target word: best messenger **Decides:** Distrust of government; credibility comes from similarity and trust.

A	Dropped element	Still from the distrusted source.
B	Correct	Trusted, similar messengers are more persuasive.
C	Confusion set	Fame is not the same as trust.
D	Inverted operation	A government figure the group distrusts.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A rumor that a childhood vaccine contains tracking microchips spreads ~~through a popular online cooking group~~. Which draft correction follows best practice?

Target word: best correction **Decides:** Lead with the fact, flag myth once, explain, repeat fact.

A	Absolute language	Some rumors spread and need a response.
B	Correct	The fact-myth-fallacy-fact pattern.
C	Adjacent category	Accurate but not accessible to the audience.
D	Inverted operation	Leads with and repeats the myth.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Crisis and emergency risk communication	Be first, be right, be credible: share what is known, what is not yet known, what people should do, and when the next update comes.	Waiting until every fact is confirmed, or over-reassuring with promises.	An unfolding event with incomplete information and a public that needs to act.
2	Plain language and health literacy	Public messages use short sentences, everyday words, and the action first, aimed at about a 6th–8th grade reading level.	Adding detail, jargon, or statistics to seem more credible.	A draft message full of technical terms.
3	Absolute vs. relative risk	Absolute risk reduction is the difference in risk (e.g., 4 in 1,000 minus 1 in 1,000); relative reduction is that difference divided by the starting risk; the public needs absolute numbers to judge size.	Presenting a large relative percentage as if it were the absolute change.	Two risks stated as “X in 1,000.”
4	Audience segmentation	Divide the audience into groups with shared needs and barriers and tailor messages and channels to each.	Using one message for everyone to be efficient.	Two audiences with clearly different concerns for the same behavior.
5	Gain vs. loss framing	Gain frames (benefits of acting) tend to work better for prevention behaviors; loss frames (costs of not acting) tend to work better for detection behaviors such as screening.	Assuming fear appeals work best for everything.	A prevention behavior (sunscreen, handwashing) vs. a detection behavior (screening test).
6	Social marketing's 4 Ps	Product is the behavior or service, price is every cost to the person (money, time, effort), place is where and when it is available, and promotion is the message.	Assuming price is zero when a service is free, or fixing access problems with more ads.	People know about a service but face a barrier to using it.
7	Trusted messengers	Messages from people the audience sees as credible and similar to themselves, such as community health workers, are more persuasive than those from distant authorities.	Assuming the highest-ranking official is always the best spokesperson.	A community that distrusts government or outsiders.
8	Correcting misinformation	Lead with the fact, mention the myth once with a warning, explain why it is wrong, and end with the fact again.	Putting the myth in the headline, which repeats and strengthens it.	A rumor spreading and a draft correction.

Course scope (public description): Public Health Capstone provides learners with real-world applications to prepare them for the public health industry. In this course, learners apply the knowledge gained through the program to real-world situations and educates the public in response to those situations.